prominent physicists who was interested in the quantum measurement problem: Eugene Wigner.

Wigner was still at Princeton, where he had, thirty years earlier, first heard about nuclear fission while in the university infirmary. In the intervening decades, Wigner's star had risen considerably: he was one of the foremost experts in mathematical physics alive and had won the Nobel Prize in 1963 for his contributions to the mathematical underpinnings of quantum physics. All the while, though, Wigner had advocated the view of quantum physics that he attributed to his friend and compatriot von Neumann (who had died in 1957). He thought that wave function collapse was a real phenomenon, and the fact that this was not incorporated into the quantum theory, he believed, merely pointed to its incompleteness. In fact, Wigner had been among the first to use the term "measurement problem," in a paper in 1963 discussing exactly this point.

The solution to the measurement problem, Wigner was convinced, lay somewhere in the special qualities of human consciousness—a view he also attributed to von Neumann. Furthermore, he didn't think there was anything controversial about this—he called this the "orthodox" view. By claiming that this was all perfectly orthodox—and by the respect that his own name commanded—Wigner managed to keep his work from being dismissed out of hand by the wider physics community, although he was not terribly successful at convincing others that consciousness had anything to do with wave function collapse. But Wigner was not dogmatic. He was willing to entertain different ideas about how quantum physics worked and how to interpret it. And he spent more time pointing out the real problem around quantum measurement than he did on promoting his own preferred solution. Over the course of the late 1950s and into the 1960s, Wigner published several papers detailing the nature of the quantum measurement problem, and pointed out flaws in various proposed solutions that claimed to resolve the problem without altering the Copenhagen interpretation or adding to the mathematical formalism of the theory. This had not earned him any friends in Copenhagen, nor had his disparaging comments on complementarity decades earlier. Zeh's mentor, Jensen, had shared the Nobel Prize in Physics with Wigner in 1963 and had sat next to Wigner at the award banquet in Stockholm afterward. The subject turned to Bohr's institute, and Jensen was surprised to hear Wigner say, "I have never been *invited* to Copenhagen."